FREE CARDS

Online Safety Rule Cards



Sixteen one-rule cards, a privacy settings checklist and a Stop and tell card. Cut them out, laminate them and keep them by the screen.

WHO IT IS FOR
Autistic children, young people and adults who use phones, tablets, games and the internet, with the parents, carers, teachers and SNAs who support them.

NCCA STAGE
Primary (senior classes) · Junior Cycle · Senior Cycle and LCA · Adults



Easy read

The internet is a public place. Some rules keep you safe there. If something feels wrong, stop and tell an adult you trust.

How to use this resource

- Print pages 2 and 3 on card or paper, cut along the dotted lines and laminate. Each card has **one rule** and one picture.
- Teach one or two cards at a time, at a calm moment, not just after something has gone wrong. Practise the words on the card out loud.
- Choose the cards that fit your age and your devices. Keep the cards by the screen, or put them in a ring or pencil case.
- Use page 4 to check the privacy settings on each device together. Page 5 has scripts to practise and notes for adults.

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Version 1.0 · online-safety-cards

My online safety rules

Cut out the cards. Sort them: rules I know, rules I am learning, rules I want to talk about.



1. Chatting

Only chat with people I know in real life. If I do not know them, I do not chat.

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2. Sharing photos

Before I post a photo, I ask: would I be happy if everyone saw this?

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3. Personal information

I keep my full name, address, school and phone number private online.

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4. Passwords

My password is private. I only share it with a parent or carer I trust.

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5. Not who they say

A person online can pretend to be someone else. I cannot be sure who they are.

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6. Meeting someone from online

I never meet someone from online on my own. I tell a trusted adult first.

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7. Location settings

I turn location sharing off in apps and photos, unless a trusted adult says it is safe.

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8. Gaming chat

Game chat is public too. I can mute, block or turn chat off.

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9. Screenshots

Anything I send can be saved, screenshotted and shared. Once sent, I cannot get it back.

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More rules, and Stop and tell



10. Block and report

If someone upsets me or scares me, I can block them and report them. It is allowed.

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11. Nobody should ask for private photos

No one has the right to ask me for a private photo. I say no. I tell an adult.

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12. Money and gifts

If someone asks for money, gift cards or game items, I stop and tell an adult.

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13. Secrets online

If someone says "keep this secret" or "do not tell your parents", I tell a trusted adult.

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14. Links and pop-ups

I do not click links or pop-ups that I do not expect. I ask an adult first.

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15. Unkind messages

If a message is unkind, I do not reply. I save it and show a trusted adult.

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16. Think before I send

I wait ten seconds before I send. Is it kind? Is it private? Would I say it face to face?

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STOP AND TELL

If something online feels wrong: 1. Stop. 2. Do not reply. 3. Tell a trusted adult. Keep telling until someone helps.

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My own rule

Write a rule for our house or class:

_____

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Privacy settings checklist

Sit with a trusted adult. Go through the settings on each device, game and app. Tick each box when it is done.

- ☐ My account is set to **private**, so only people I choose can see my posts.
- ☐ My profile name does not show my full name, school or town.
- ☐ My profile photo does not show my school uniform or my house.
- ☐ **Location sharing** is off in my phone, camera and apps.
- ☐ Only **friends I know in real life** can message me or send friend requests.
- ☐ In games, chat is set to friends only, or turned off.
- ☐ I have a strong password that is not used anywhere else, and I know who keeps a copy.
- ☐ Two-step login is turned on if the app has it.
- ☐ I know how to **block**, **mute** and **report** in each app I use.
- ☐ I have a trusted adult who knows which apps and games I use.

Check each device or app together

Step	Done	Need help
Phone		
Tablet or computer		
Games console		
Favourite game		
Favourite app		

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Easy read



The internet is public.



I keep my private things private.



People online can pretend.



I can say no and block.



I tell a trusted adult.

Scripts to practise

Someone you do not know sends a message.



I do not know you. I am not chatting.

Someone asks for a private photo.



No. I am telling an adult now.

A friend wants your password.



My password is private. I do not share it.

A gamer asks where you live.



I do not share that. I am blocking you.

You see something that scares you online.



I need to tell you something. Can you help me?

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You are not sure if something is safe.

I am not sure about this. Can you check it with me?

Nobody should ask for private photos

- No one has the right to ask you for a sexual or private photo. This is true even if they are a friend, a partner or someone you like.
- If someone does, say no, do not reply, **keep the messages** and tell a trusted adult. It is never your fault.

Notes for adults

- Teach the rules **before** there is a problem. Use the same words at home and at school. Pick two or three cards for each term, rather than all sixteen at once.
- Many autistic young people are very literal. "Stranger" can be confusing, because people online feel like friends. The card says: **someone I have not met in real life, or cannot be sure about**.
- Autistic people can find it hard to spot hidden meanings or when kindness is being used to get something. Practise the scripts calmly. Role-play with a puppet or in writing if speaking is hard.
- Make telling safe. If a child tells you about something online, stay calm, thank them and do not remove their device as a first response. Fear of losing the device stops children telling.
- Reports can be made on the platform itself, and images can be reported at hotline.ie. Webwise (webwise.ie) has advice for parents and teachers. Coimisiún na Meán is the online safety regulator.
- Check the age rating of apps and games. Review settings together every few months, as apps change them.
- A child who tells you about anything that worries you about their safety: follow *Children First* (2017). In school, tell the Designated Liaison Person (DLP) the same day.

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Curriculum links

NCCA and Department of Education alignment

- Primary SPHE (1999), strand **Myself and the Wider World**, strand unit *Media education*, and strand **Myself**, strand unit *Safety and protection*; supported by the Stay Safe programme.
- Junior Cycle SPHE (2023), Strand 2 **Making Healthy Choices** and Strand 3 **Relationships and Sexuality**, including safe and respectful online behaviour.
- Senior Cycle SPHE (new specification published 2024) and LCA Social Education.
- NCCA guidance on RSE for students with special educational needs: use visual supports, scripts and consistent language.

Universal Design for Learning

Every Autism & Me resource offers more than one way in: pictures and words together, an easy-read line, things to do with your hands, and scripts to practise. Keep the learning aim the same for everyone, and change the route. No diagnosis is needed to use any support in this resource.

Getting support in Ireland

Webwise

Online safety advice for parents, teachers and young people at webwise.ie.

Hotline.ie

Report intimate images shared without consent, and child sexual abuse material, at hotline.ie. They can help get images removed.

Childline (ISPCC)

Free, 24 hours: phone 1800 66 66 66, text 50101, or chat at childline.ie. For anyone under 18.

An Garda Síochána

Contact your local Garda station, or 112 or 999 in an emergency. Garda Confidential Line: 1800 666 111.

Text About It

Free text support any time: text HELLO to 50808.

Parentline

Support for parents and carers: 01 873 3500, parentline.ie.

Autism & Me

Questions about this resource or training for your school: contactautismandme@gmail.com · autismandme.ie

If a child tells you something worrying

Stay calm. Listen, and believe them. Do not promise to keep it a secret. Write down what they said in their own words, with the date. Pass it on the same day: in a school, to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP); otherwise to Tusla. If anyone is in immediate danger, call 112 or 999. Follow *Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children* (2017).

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